

triotis like A.B. Vajpayee, L.K. Advani has shown his own avariciousness ("The Rising Hate Scion", April 13). He can perhaps go to any extent to achieve his goal—the prime minister's post. By defending Varun, he has put a big question mark on his credentials. If Varun is the new youth icon, then God help this country. His kind of politics will only create a great divide. Perhaps this short stint in jail would make the young man careful, in politics at least.

D.B.N. MURTHY,

via [www.indiatoday.in](http://www.indiatoday.in)

## The War Within

Pakistan is at war with itself ("Crimson Tide", April 6). It is ferociously battling the enemy within—the terrorists and militants—who consider themselves to be far truer followers of Islam than those who oppose them. Yet there are few others who continue to blame US foreign policy and the ever-potent "foreign hand" for the wave of terrorism sweeping through the country. The mainstream political parties need to draw a line and tell the world where they stand. The religio-political parties must also make their positions clear.

K.S. JAYATHEERTHA,

via [www.indiatoday.in](http://www.indiatoday.in)

## Let Law Prevail

The issue of reinstatement of deposed Chief Justice of Pakistan Iftikhar

Muhammad Chaudhry was conveniently sidelined and forgotten by President Asif Zardari ("Sharif Power", March 30). Zardari had even outperformed Gen. Pervez Musharraf in his attempt to stifle Nawaz Sharif. With Chaudhry back in office, the combined strength of the people and judiciary will perhaps help thwart the evil intentions of Pakistan's elected government.

S. LAKSHMI,

via [www.indiatoday.in](http://www.indiatoday.in)

but since we are nowhere close to achieving this goal, the least that the political leaders can do is to try and ensure the welfare of the citizens, especially the children in whose hands lies its future.

SNEHAL BISWAS,

via [www.indiatoday.in](http://www.indiatoday.in)

## Dangerous Games

Every year a number of innocent students suffer silently in the name of ragging ("Ragged to Death", March 30). This



**Shashi Tharoor's nomination as a candidate from Thiruvananthapuram is a bright move by the Congress. All political parties should give opportunities to people of such calibre.**

V.S. GANESAN, *Bangalore*

## Dark Future

Who says slave trade has been abolished ("Children for Sale", March 30)? It is still present and that too in a very ugly form in Bihar where the orphaned and homeless are being openly bought and sold. It is shameful for a society like ours. The founding fathers aimed at making our country a welfare state,

life-snatching and tormenting act is yet to be handled strongly by our Government. Should all of us sit back peacefully and ask, "who next"? Those who do take part in this heinous act should be awarded exemplary punishment. This killing game called 'ragging' should be banned immediately before more Amanns are lost.

AGYATAA GUPTA, *Tezpur*

**30**  
YEARS  
AGO IN  
INDIA  
TODAY

JUNE 1-15, 1979

## Balancing Act

By threatening to resign from the cabinet last month—though characteristically, not in so many words—if the railwaymen's demand was not met, George Fernandes, the maverick minister of industry, put on one of his cat-on-a-hot-tin-roof acts on the country's turbulent political stage. The act, a Fernandes special, bore an uncanny resemblance to the opening scenes of the spectacular nation-wide railway strike he spearheaded in 1974, an event that made him a national hero to millions and an insufferable pain in the nether regions to an equal number of people. It also lifted him three years later to a posh ministerial bungalow in New Delhi's tree-lined Motilal Nehru Marg from a dingy high-security cell 15 miles away in Tihar Central Jail into which Mrs Indira Gandhi had flung him on a treason charge.



GEORGE FERNANDES

Readers are recommended to make appropriate enquiries before sending money, incurring expenses or entering into commitments in relation to any advertisement appearing in this publication. The India Today Group does not vouch for any claims made by the advertisers of products and services. The printer, publisher, editor-in-chief and the editor of the India Today Group publications shall not be held liable for any consequences in the event of such claims not being honoured by the advertisers.

E-MAIL YOUR LETTERS TO: [letters.editor@intoday.com](mailto:letters.editor@intoday.com)

FAX THEM TO: 011-23316180

OR LOG ON TO: [www.indiatoday.in](http://www.indiatoday.in)